

John DeSouza

Director of Product Design

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PROFILE

Design leader with 13+ years shipping fintech, web3, and ecommerce products. Manages a distributed four-person design team organized by customer journey stage. Delivers measured business outcomes: \$2.654M incremental originations from organic traffic, 65% of users rating a redesigned financial health product better than competitors, and 25M LINK staked within 3 hours of a product launch.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Design Leadership: Team hiring and coaching, design critique and quality gates, distributed and async team management, multi-product portfolio ownership

Fintech and Lending UX: Borrower journeys, servicing flows, onboarding and activation, trust signals, financial data presentation

Metrics-Driven Design: Funnel analysis, A/B testing and experimentation, behavioral metrics, data-informed prioritization

Systems and Cross-Functional: Design systems, Figma, progressive disclosure, partnership with product and engineering on strategy and execution

EXPERIENCE

Director of Product Design II | Best Egg

Apr 2024 – Present

Multi-Product Portfolio: Lending, Credit & Debt Management

- Led cross-sell funnel strategy converting loan declines into secondary product offers. Designed qualifying questions, progressive disclosure, and contextual redirects. Result: \$2.654M total incremental originations from organic traffic (Oct 2025–Jan 2026).
- Inherited a financial health product with low engagement. Diagnosed the root cause as an information-dense dashboard with no actionable guidance. Redesigned from data-heavy to insight-first. Result: 65% of users rated it better than competing financial tools (n=114); 70% continued using it after account setup; 68% cited simplicity and ease of use.
- Built a reusable design system for financial data presentation, status indicators, and trust signals across lending, credit, and debt management surfaces, reducing design cycles and enabling consistent quality at scale.
- Leads a PA/CA distributed team using async-first rituals and Figma-first collaboration across a 3-hour time gap. Established a critique process that improved quality while shortening review cycles.

Head of Experience | Charm Solutions

Dec 2022 – Apr 2024

AI-Powered Credit Scoring for Small Businesses

- Led product vision and UX strategy for an AI-powered credit scoring platform. Designed the onboarding flow connecting business data to the credit model. Partnered with the AI/ML team to make model outputs human-centered and interpretable for non-technical users.

Senior Product Design Manager | Chainlink Labs

Dec 2021 – Dec 2022

Web3 Staking & Developer Activation

- Led design for a crypto staking interface (v0.1) for non-technical LINK token holders, solving for self-custody, token locking, and reward transparency in a single flow. Result: 25M LINK staked, with v0.1 reaching full capacity within 3 hours of launch. Interface remained unchanged for 12+ months post-launch.
- Led developer onboarding UX across Chainlink's core product suite (CCIP, Data Feeds, VRF, Automation), applying progressive disclosure to reduce cognitive load across technically complex APIs.
- Scaled the design team from 3 to 5 across WA, CA, and HI. Established async-first design reviews spanning 8 time zones.

Product Design Manager | Auth0**Sept 2020 – Dec 2021***Identity & Access Management — Onboarding & Developer Activation*

- Led design for a no-code authentication flow builder enabling non-technical users to configure complex identity logic without engineering support. Shipped to 35,000+ customers and became a core product offering.
- Led design for Sign-in with Ethereum (SIWE) in partnership with SpruceID, solving the tension between self-custody security and mainstream usability. Positive user testing results led to expanded Web3 integrations at Auth0.
- Managed 7 senior designers across the US, Canada, France, and Argentina. Grew the team from 3 to 7 while retaining all original members. Shipped cross-timezone projects across 4 time zones.

Product Design Manager | ShopRunner**Oct 2018 – Sept 2020**

- Led design for checkout and cart activation flows serving millions of transactions. Optimized for first-purchase conversion through iterative testing with product and engineering.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

STEMchain — Co-Founder / Product Design | Jan 2018 – Oct 2019 | Blockchain-based donation platform for STEM nonprofits.

eMoney Advisor — Senior UX Designer | Jan 2016 – Oct 2018 | Advisor platform and client interfaces for high-net-worth wealth management.

Comcast & Ciright — UX Designer | 2013 – 2015 | Telecommunications and software services.

EDUCATION

Art Institute of Philadelphia — Bachelor of Science, Graphic Design | Dec 2012